

VERONIKA DERGAL

Product Manager | Building AI-powered tools | 10+ years HR consulting & Executive Search

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PM Portfolio: <https://veronikadergal.github.io/VD-Portfolio/>

SUMMARY

Product Manager with 10 years in HR, consulting and executive search. Building AI-powered tools that solve real operational problems. Reduced manual research time by 70%, saving 280 hours per project. Shipping working products with no-code and AI tools - prototype-first, comfortable turning ambiguous problems into working solutions fast. Seeking PM roles at fast-moving companies where I can build, test, and iterate.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Consultant, Veredus | London, UK

Apr 2023 - Jan 2026

- Built AI-enabled automation tool from 0→1 using no-code/vibe coding tools (Lovable), cutting manual research time by 70% (280 hours saved annually) - owned full product lifecycle: discovery, requirements, stakeholder buy-in, engineering collaboration, and team adoption.
- Translated ambiguous search requirements into clear selection criteria, including using publication data to help identify researchers matching highly specific role requirements.
- Designed and implemented Asana-based workflow system, reducing administrative overhead by ~150 hours/year through improved visibility and stakeholder alignment.
- Championed Metaview adoption as an ambassador, standardising AI meeting notes across calls to reduce admin and stay present in conversations.
- Led international executive search campaigns, managing stakeholders across universities, search committees, and candidates; successfully placed 32 senior leaders in UK Higher Education.

People Partner (HQ Teams), Fozzy Group | Kyiv, Ukraine

Jan 2021 - Mar 2023

- Built onboarding platform from 0→1: defined requirements, wrote user stories, and collaborated with engineering/design to ship welcome page with automated workflows and pulse surveys.
- Reduced new hire turnover from 29% → 18% in 12 months by improving early employee experience and using survey data to identify and address friction points.
- Designed and launched company's first Performance Management cycle for 300+ employees, balancing stakeholder priorities (fairness, budget constraints, retention goals).
- Adapted HR processes during wartime, introducing retention and mental health resilience initiatives under extreme constraints.

Associate, Odgers Berndtson | Kyiv, Ukraine

Feb 2019 - Nov 2020

- Managed end-to-end executive search for C-suite roles, balancing client expectations, candidate experience, and tight timelines. Placed 10+ senior executives across various sectors.

Consultant, EY | Kyiv, Ukraine

Dec 2015 - Nov 2018

- Led enterprise transformation research and workshops for companies with 7K-60K employees; progressed from intern to consultant in 3 years.
 - Conducted market research and competitive analysis on HR trends, EVPs, and workforce analytics to inform strategic recommendations.
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EDUCATION & CERTIFICATES

2011 - 2014

BA, International Business Management

University of Lincoln, UK

March 2026

IBM AI Product Manager

Coursera, Professional Certificate - [Verify](#)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Product & Analytics Tools: Amplitude (certified), Claude Code & Design, Lovable, GitHub, Asana, Stitch, Miro.
- Personal Project: [Stride](#) - B2C goal-setting app.
- Languages: English, Ukrainian.
- Recent courses: Analytics - Amplitude Foundations; IBM AI Product Manager certification; AI for everyone (DeepLearning.AI); Agentic AI (DeepLearning.AI).